Basemental MasterDesk Mastering Suite – User Manual

Nov 8, 2026 · @Charles McDougald

Welcome

Basemental MasterDesk Mastering Suite puts a complete analog-style mastering chain in one plug-in: two EQs, two compressors, tubes, a brickwall maximizer and an automatic mastering assistant. This manual covers version 1.13.0 for macOS, Windows and Linux, as VST3, AU, AAX (Pro Tools) and a standalone app.

What is inside:

- **Parametric Mastering EQ**: a three-band parametric with high and low shelves, modelled on the Sontec MES-432C/9 style of mastering EQ.
- **Passive EQ**: a four-band passive equalizer with high-pass and low-pass filters, in the style of the Manley Massive Passive mastering version, plus a tube make-up stage.
- **Stereo Variable Mu Limiter Compressor**: a tube-style vari-mu compressor with COMPRESS and LIMIT modes.
- **M/S Class-A Compressor**: a clean, fast compressor with feedback and feed-forward modes, Mid/Side processing and a soft clipper, in the style of the elysia alpha compressor.
- **Auto Master + Maximizer**: listens to your song, sets EQ, compression and loudness for the genre you choose, and stops peaks at the ceiling you set.
- **Meters and tools**: input and output VU meters, gain-reduction and harmonics meters, a 62-band spectrum, LUFS loudness, a vectorscope, song key detection and KEY SHIFT.

The suite models the behaviour of the hardware it is styled on; it is not affiliated with or endorsed by Sontec, Manley or elysia.

What the units are modeled after

The suite's two EQs and two compressors are modeled on four classic mastering units: two equalizers and two compressors with opposite characters, so you can choose silky or warm EQ and creamy or transparent compression.

In the plug-in	Modeled after	Category	Main technology	Sonic signature	Primary use
Parametric Mastering EQ	Sontec MES-432C/9	Equalizer	Discrete solid-state	Silky, pristine, transparent, wide	Premium air and clarity
Passive EQ	Manley Massive Passive (mastering version)	Equalizer	Passive circuit with tubes	Warm, thick, organic, interactive	Character shaping and musical vibe
Stereo Variable Mu Limiter Compressor	Manley Variable Mu	Compressor	Vacuum tubes	Creamy, cohesive, glued	Master bus glue and smoothing
M/S Class-A Compressor	elysia alpha compressor	Compressor	Discrete Class-A solid-state	Transparent, surgical, punchy	Master dynamic control and M/S work

Sontec MES-432C/9 → Parametric Mastering EQ

- **What it is:** a legendary, fully stepped stereo parametric equalizer.
- **Reputation:** widely considered the "Holy Grail" of mastering EQs. Its maker, Burgess Macneal, invented the parametric EQ with George Massenburg; they introduced it in 1971 (Wikipedia).
- **Sonic character:** famous for a pristine, ultra-smooth, "silky" top end. You can boost aggressively for air and clarity without it sounding harsh or grainy, or upsetting the stereo image.

Manley Massive Passive → Passive EQ

- **What it is:** a four-band, two-channel tube and passive equalizer.
- **Reputation:** a staple of top-tier studios. It shapes the sound with only capacitors, inductors and resistors, and uses a tube stage purely to restore the level.
- **Sonic character:** unlike surgical EQs, it makes broad, interactive, organic curves. It is thick and musical, often used to add a warm, rich vibe to the midrange and a sheen to the top of a mix.

Manley Variable Mu → Stereo Variable Mu Limiter Compressor

- **What it is:** an all-tube stereo limiter and compressor.

- **Reputation:** "Variable Mu" is Manley's trademarked take on a classic style of tube compression, dating back to vintage Fairchild units, in which the tubes themselves adjust the volume.
- **Sonic character:** the classic "mix glue" compressor. Rather than clamping hard, it behaves like a soft-knee leveler with a warm, creamy, cohesive texture. A Massive Passive running into a Variable Mu is famously called the "killer combination" for mastering; the Warm & Analog master chains use exactly that pairing.

elysia alpha compressor → M/S Class-A Compressor

- **What it is:** a modern, premium, discrete Class-A stereo and Mid/Side mastering compressor.
- **Reputation:** the opposite of the warm, tube-driven Manley: modern German engineering, with the hardware at about $13,450 (Sweetwater).
- **Sonic character:** transparent, precise and punchy, built to control wild dynamics without colouring the sound. It has built-in Mid/Side processing (compress the centre vocal apart from guitars at the sides), a soft-clip limiter, and a tilt EQ (Niveau) to rebalance brightness quickly.

These are independent models built from the units' published controls and behaviour. MasterDesk is not affiliated with or endorsed by Sontec, Manley or elysia, and all names are trademarks of their owners.

Installing

Run the installer for your computer, then let your DAW rescan its plug-ins. The suite appears as **MasterDesk Mastering Suite** by Basemental, in the EQ and Dynamics categories.

Computer	Installer	What it installs, and where
macOS	`.pkg`	VST3 → `/Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/VST3` · AU → `/Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/Components` · Pro Tools (AAX) → `/Library/Application Support/Avid/Audio/Plug-Ins` · app → `/Applications`

Computer	Installer	What it installs, and where
Windows	Setup `.exe`	VST3 → `C:\Program Files\Common Files\VST3` · Pro Tools (AAX) → `C:\Program Files\Common Files\Avid\Audio\Plug-Ins` · standalone app
Linux	`.tar.gz` with `install.sh`	VST3 → `~/.vst3` · standalone app → `~/.local/bin`

Each installer lets you tick or untick the parts you want. Installing over an older version replaces it, and also removes old copies named "Masterdesk Passive EQ".

Every installer also puts this manual on your computer as a PDF: on macOS next to the app in `/Applications`, on Windows in the program folder with a **User Manual** shortcut in the Start menu, and on Linux in `~/.local/share/doc/masterdesk-mastering-suite`. The download zips carry a copy too. In the plug-in, press **HELP ?** and then **OPEN MANUAL**.

First launch warnings

- **macOS**: an installer that is not signed and notarized shows "Apple could not verify … is free of malware". Right-click the `.pkg` and choose **Open**, or go to **System Settings → Privacy & Security → Open Anyway**. Signed builds open without a warning.
- **Windows**: SmartScreen may warn about an unsigned installer. Click **More info → Run anyway**.
- **Logic Pro** checks every AU the first time it starts after installing; wait for it to finish.

Pro Tools

Pro Tools uses the AAX version. Retail Pro Tools loads only AAX plug-ins signed with PACE's wraptool; an unsigned build loads only in **Pro Tools Developer**, a free version from your Avid developer account.

To sign it, install the plug-in with the Pro Tools (AAX) option, plug in your iLok, then run the script for your computer from the project's `installer/aax` folder:

- macOS: `sign_aax_mac.sh <PACE account> <wrap GUID> "Developer ID Application: Your Name (TEAMID)"`
- Windows (Administrator prompt): `sign_aax_windows.bat <PACE account> <wrap GUID> certificate.p12 <password>`

The PACE account, wrap configuration GUID and the wraptool program come from PACE once Avid has enrolled you as an AAX developer.

The standalone app

The app runs without a DAW: open it, choose your audio interface in its settings, and play audio through it. Everything works the same as in a DAW.

Quick start: master a song in five minutes

Put the plug-in last on your master (stereo) bus, choose a genre, press LISTEN and play the song; the Auto Master sets everything else.

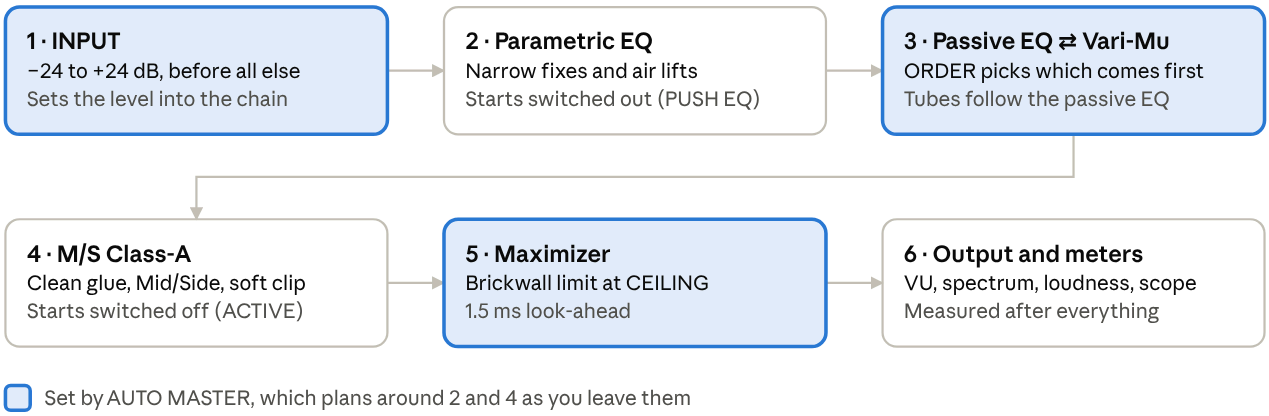
1. Insert **MasterDesk Mastering Suite** as the last plug-in on the stereo output, with nothing after it.
2. In the **AUTO MASTER** plate, pick a **GENRE**: POP, JAZZ, 70′S, 80′S, 90′S, R&B or HIP HOP.
3. Press **LISTEN** and play the fullest part of the song. After about 30 seconds of music it plans the master and applies it.
4. Watch the blue display: the mix (steel blue), the genre′s target (white dashes) and the result (aqua), with the loudness before and after.
5. Listen. Turn **AMOUNT** down for a lighter touch, or try another genre; it re-plans at once from the same recording.
6. Check the **LOUDNESS** panel: INTEGRATED should sit near your target and TRUE PEAK MAX below −1 dBTP.
7. Don′t like it? Press **UNDO** to get your own settings back.

Everything the Auto Master sets stays adjustable, so you can fine-tune any knob afterwards. If you′d rather start by hand, pick a preset from the **PRESET** menu in the footer, or from the **PRESETS** button on any EQ or compressor.

Signal flow and the faceplate

Sound passes through the units in a fixed order, so an EQ move always reaches the compressors and the maximizer always has the last word.

Sound flows through six stages, top left to bottom right



Set by AUTO MASTER, which plans around 2 and 4 as you leave them

signal flow · 6 stages

The only order you choose is between the passive EQ and the Vari-Mu (the **ORDER** switch). Meters read the final output.

The faceplate, top to bottom

Area	What is there
Top bar	INPUT knob and meter, VU LEFT / RIGHT, HARMONICS meter, TUBE STAGE glass tubes, DRIVE and TUBE ON, jewel lamps
Screens	SPECTRUM, SONG KEY with KEY SHIFT, VECTORSCOPE, LOUDNESS
Parametric Mastering EQ (black panel)	Shelves and three bands per channel, PUSH EQ
Passive EQ (LEFT and RIGHT rows)	Four bands, FILTERS and TRIM per channel
Stereo Variable Mu (gray plate)	Compressor strips per channel, ORDER switch, gain-reduction meters
M/S Class-A (ash-blue plate)	Compressor per channel, STEREO / M/S, LINK, SOFT CLIP
Auto Master + Maximizer	GENRE, LISTEN, AMOUNT, UNDO, the blue display, maximizer GAIN and CEILING
Footer	LINK, L > R, R > L, PRESET menu, SIZE, MINI, FULL SCREEN, SCROLL, HELP ?

Every EQ and compressor plate has **POP OUT** and **PRESETS** buttons in its top-left corner.

The window: size, scroll, zoom and pop-outs

The panel is tall, so the window offers several ways to see it at a comfortable size; all of them are remembered with your session.

To do this	Do this
Make it bigger or smaller	Choose 60, 70, 85 or 100 % in the **SIZE** menu (footer), or drag the bottom-right corner. Everything scales in proportion.

To do this	Do this
Make it wider	Grab the chrome handle on the left or right edge and pull sideways, up to 2.2× the standard width. The panel spreads out (wider spectrum, wider knob rows); nothing is squashed. Pull up or down to make it bigger.
Read it larger on a small screen	Press **SCROLL** (footer). The panel fills the window's width; hover near the top or bottom edge to glide up or down (faster nearer the edge), or use the mouse wheel. Press **SCROLL ON** to return.
Turn hover scrolling on or off	Press **HOVER ON** (footer, next to SCROLL) to switch it to **HOVER OFF**. Resting the mouse near an edge then no longer scrolls or pans; the mouse wheel and dragging still work. Press again to turn it back on. The setting is saved with your session.
Magnify one area	Double-click an empty spot (a plate, screen or label) to zoom in 2× there; double-click again to zoom out. **Ctrl/Cmd + mouse wheel** zooms smoothly from 1× to 4×. While zoomed, hover an edge, drag an empty spot or use the wheel to look around.
Open one unit in its own window	Click **POP OUT** in the unit's top-left corner. The window is a live view: knobs move in both places and meters run in both. Open as many as you like; closing one doesn't stop the unit.
Watch only the meters	Press **MINI** (footer) for VU, harmonics, input, spectrum, vectorscope and loudness. **FULL PANEL** brings everything back.
Fill the screen	Press **FULL SCREEN** (footer); **EXIT FULL** returns.
Get help on a control	Hover it for a tooltip, or press **HELP ?** for the full guide page.

On a small laptop screen the plug-in shrinks to fit rather than running off the screen. Double-clicking a knob resets it; zoom only happens on empty spots, so you never lose that.

The units and their controls

Every knob clicks through detents like the hardware, every control can be automated, and double-clicking a knob resets it. With **LINK** on (footer), the right channel follows the left on every unit.

Input and meters (top of the panel)

Control or display	What it does
INPUT	−24 to +24 dB of gain before everything else. The LED meter under it turns amber above −6 dBFS and red above −1 dBFS.
VU LEFT / RIGHT	Average output level with real VU ballistics; 0 VU = −18 dBFS RMS. The lamp under each flashes on peaks above −1 dBFS.
HARMONICS	How much colour the tubes add, in % THD: under 0.3 % is a subtle sheen, 1 % and up is audible saturation.
Jewel lamps	SIGNAL (green), LINK (yellow), CLIP (red, output over 0 dBFS), TUBE (amber).
SPECTRUM	62 pin meters from 19 Hz to 19 kHz, 0 to −62 dB, with peak-hold dots. Heads turn amber above −18 dB and red within 6 dB of full scale.
VECTORSCOPE	The stereo image (tall = centred, wide = stereo), a balance meter and phase correlation (above 0 = mono-safe).
LOUDNESS	EBU R128: integrated, short-term, momentary, true peak, LRA, PLR and PSR. Pick a TARGET (−14 streaming, −16 Apple Music, −23 EBU, −24 ATSC, −9 loud); INTEGRATED turns green within ±1 LU. RESET clears it.

Parametric Mastering EQ (first in the chain)

A precise parametric for surgical and air moves. Press the red **PUSH EQ** to switch it in (it starts switched out); **MAN / OFF** switches each channel.

The column at the right of the unit holds its own level controls. **INPUT** trims the level going into the EQ and **OUTPUT** sets the level leaving it, each from −12 to +12 dB in 0.5 dB steps (double-click a knob for 0 dB). The **METER** between them shows the left and right peak level after OUTPUT: green below −6 dBFS, amber up to −1 dBFS, red above, with a white tick that holds the peak for 2 seconds. Use INPUT to give the bands headroom before a big boost, and OUTPUT to match the level with PUSH EQ in and out so you judge the tone, not the loudness. Both work only while PUSH EQ is lit, and loading a preset sets them back to 0 dB.

Control	Range
LO band	11–570 Hz
MID band	125–6,800 Hz
HI band	3.4–25 kHz
SHAPE (each band)	5 / 6 / 9 / 11 / 15 dB/oct, wide to narrow; narrower shapes give slightly less peak gain, which keeps narrow moves smooth
LEVEL (each band)	±9 dB: 0.5 dB steps to 3 dB, then 1 dB steps
HI shelf	8 kHz, or 12 kHz with its switch
LO shelf	100 Hz, or 50 Hz with its switch
INPUT	−12 to +12 dB, 0.5 dB steps, into the EQ
OUTPUT	−12 to +12 dB, 0.5 dB steps, out of the EQ
METER	L/R peak after OUTPUT, −48 to 0 dBFS, 2-second peak hold

Passive EQ (one row per channel)

Four broad, musical bands. Each band has **FREQ** (11 steps), **GAIN** (16 detents; the cream window shows the real dB), **BANDWIDTH** (wide to narrow), **BOOST / OUT / CUT**, and **BELL / SHELF** (the low two bands shelve low, the high two shelve high).

Band	Frequencies (Hz)
LOW	22, 33, 47, 68, 100, 150, 220, 330, 470, 680, 1k

Band	Frequencies (Hz)
LOW MID	82, 120, 180, 270, 390, 560, 820, 1.2k, 1.8k, 2.7k, 3.9k
HIGH MID	220, 330, 470, 680, 1k, 1.5k, 2.2k, 3.3k, 4.7k, 6.8k, 10k
HIGH	560, 820, 1.2k, 1.8k, 2.7k, 3.9k, 5.6k, 8.2k, 12k, 16k, 27k

FILTERS and TRIM: **HIGH PASS** off / 12 / 16 / 23 / 30 / 39 Hz, **LOW PASS** off / 52k / 40k / 27k / 20k / 15k, **GAIN TRIM** ±2.5 dB, **EQ IN** bypasses the EQ.

Tube stage

TUBE ON switches the tube colour in; **DRIVE** (−6 to +18 dB) pushes harder for more harmonics while the output level stays matched. The glass tubes glow with level and drive.

Stereo Variable Mu Limiter Compressor (gray plate)

Smooth tube-style leveling for glue. **ORDER** sets EQ > COMP (the default) or COMP > EQ.

Control	Range	Tip
THRESHOLD	0 to −30 dBFS, 1.5 dB steps	Lower it until the meter shows 1–3 dB on loud parts
ATTACK	2 to 70 ms	Slower lets transients through
RECOVERY	0.2 to 8 s	Slower is the least audible
OUTPUT	0 to +12 dB	Make-up gain
MIX	0 to 100 %	Blend with the dry signal for parallel compression
COMPRESS / LIMIT	switch	About 1.5:1 rising to 4:1, or 4:1 rising to 20:1
HP SC	on / off	Keeps bass below 100 Hz from pumping the mix
IN / BYPASS	switch	Click-free bypass

M/S Class-A Compressor (ash-blue plate)

Clean, fast control with Mid/Side processing. Switch it on with **ACTIVE**; choose **STEREO** or **M/S** (left = Mid, right = Side).

Control	Range
THRESHOLD	+2 to −31 dBFS
FEEDBACK / FEED FWD	Feedback is smooth with a soft knee; feed forward doubles the ratios and runs on into limiting
RATIO	1:1.1 to 1:2.5, then X
ATTACK / RELEASE	0.01–150 ms / 60 ms–1.8 s, each with **AUTO FAST**
SC filter	Tilts what the detector hears, 30 Hz–3.3 kHz
NIVEAU	A tilt EQ after the compressor, 20 Hz–2 kHz (×10)
GAIN / MIX	0–12 dB make-up / dry to compressed
WARM	Softens fast transients
SOFT CLIP	A clipper at the output with its own threshold (−12 to 0 dB) and LED

Maximizer (beside the Auto Master)

The last stage: a look-ahead brickwall limiter. **GAIN** (−12 to +18 dB) pushes into it, **CEILING** (−3 to 0 dBFS) is the highest peak that can come out; −1 dB is the safe choice for streaming. Up to 2–3 dB on the GR bar stays clean; a constant 5–6 dB starts to flatten the punch. Its 1.5 ms delay is always reported to your DAW, so switching it never shifts timing.

Song key and KEY SHIFT

The SONG KEY panel shows the song's key, Camelot code and key signature from the last 20 seconds; **RELEARN** starts over. With **KEY SHIFT** on, **SEMITONES** (−12 to +12) and **FINE** (±50 cents) move the whole song to a new key, and **FORMANT** keeps voices natural. It adds 85 ms of latency only while on, so switch it while stopped; shifts of 1–3 semitones sound most natural.

Auto Master + Maximizer

The Auto Master listens to 30 seconds of your song and sets the passive EQ, tubes, filters, Vari-Mu and maximizer to land the song on its genre's sound and loudness.

What it does, in order

1. Measures the mix's tonal balance in 10 octave bands, using only the louder passages (silence is skipped).
2. Compares it with the genre's target curve.
3. Fits the passive EQ to the difference with a few broad, gentle moves (at most ±6 dB, scaled by **AMOUNT**).
4. Sets INPUT so the mix arrives at about −16 LUFS, then sets the tubes, filters and compressor for the style, with the genre's amount of gain reduction.
5. Sets the maximizer gain that lands the song on the genre's loudness.
6. Measures the real loudness for a few seconds and corrects the maximizer by up to two small steps.

Your **Parametric EQ** and **Class-A** settings are kept exactly as you set them and are included in the plan, so it matches what you hear with every unit on.

Genre	Target loudness
HIP HOP	−9 LUFS
POP	−10 LUFS
R&B	−10 LUFS
90'S	−10.5 LUFS
80'S	−12 LUFS
70'S	−14 LUFS
JAZZ	−16 LUFS

The targets are stylistic starting points, not measurements of particular records.

Tips

- Play the fullest, loudest section while it listens; a quiet intro gives a weaker plan.

- Clicking another genre or moving **AMOUNT** re-plans at once from the same recording, with no need to listen again.
- A "heavy limiting" message means the mix has big peaks: lower AMOUNT, use less maximizer GAIN or choose a quieter genre.
- **UNDO** returns every setting to how it was before the Auto Master changed it.

Presets and master chains

The suite has 88 presets, each in one category, and every EQ preset loads a complete master chain: both EQs, both compressors and the maximizer, set to work together.

Menu section	Categories
MASTER CHAINS	Clean & Corrective · Balanced Polish · Warm & Analog · Bright & Open · Loud & Punchy
COMPRESSOR PRESETS	Mix Bus · Vocals · Drums · Bass · Guitars & Keys
TRACK PRESETS	Keys & Pads · Guitars · Drums

Where to choose them

Where	What it changes
PRESET menu (footer)	Everything: an EQ preset loads its whole chain; a compressor preset sets its compressor with the rest neutral.
PRESETS on either EQ	The whole chain, while *Set up the complete master chain* is ticked (the first menu item; on by default). Untick it to change only the EQs.
PRESETS on the Vari-Mu or Class-A	Only that compressor.

How a master chain flows

EQ preset → second EQ → Vari-Mu → Class-A → Maximizer

- **Second EQ**: stays neutral so the curve passes through untouched, unless a small complementary move helps. A warm curve that lifts the lows gets −0.5 dB at 250 Hz to keep them clear; a bright curve that lifts the top gets −0.5 dB at 3.5 kHz to keep it

smooth. Engineer and track curves already use both EQs.

- **Compressors**: chosen by the curve's character. The chain uses one, or both in series when both help, and switches off the one it doesn't use. A preset with its own compressor keeps it.
- **Maximizer**: on as a safety limiter (gain 0 dB, ceiling −1 dB), so it only catches peaks. Push its GAIN, or use the Auto Master, for loudness.

Category	Count	Compressor(s) in the chain
Clean & Corrective	9	Class-A clean glue: 2:1, 30 ms, auto release, about 1 dB
Balanced Polish	6	Vari-Mu gentle glue: about 1.5:1, 45 ms, 1.2 s, about 1.5 dB (*Init (Flat)* switches everything out)
Warm & Analog	7	Vari-Mu tube glue: about 1.5:1, 35 ms, 0.8 s, about 2 dB
Bright & Open	8	Class-A clean glue, about 1.5 dB
Loud & Punchy	4	Both: Vari-Mu glue (about 2 dB) into Class-A punch (4:1, 30 ms, auto release, about 1.5 dB, soft clip at −1 dB)

Thresholds are set for those amounts on a typical pre-master; adjust them until the meters show about that much. After choosing, hover the menu or button: the tooltip shows the preset's notes and its chain.

Where the presets come from

- **Factory** curves and classic mastering moves, now sorted into the master categories.
- **From the Manley manuals**: Massive Passive *Stacked High Shelves* (Bright & Open) and five Variable Mu settings (Compressor presets).
- **Engineer presets**: settings from supplied lists of well-known engineers' techniques, as given; not verified with or endorsed by the engineers named. Their stereo-master EQ curves are in the master categories; their compressor settings are under COMPRESSOR PRESETS.
- **Track presets** (16): an EQ and matching compressor for one instrument on its own track: synth pad, electric piano, synth keys/organ, upright and grand piano; rhythm electric, hollow body, semi-hollow, Strat, Telecaster and acoustic guitar; kick, snare,

toms, overheads and drum bus. This EQ's high-pass stops at 39 Hz, so their low-cut is a low-shelf cut.

Your own settings are saved with your DAW session; to reuse a setting on other songs, use your DAW's preset save.

Workflows and tips

Small moves usually win in mastering: a good starting rule is under 2 dB of EQ per band and 1–3 dB of compression.

Mastering by hand

1. Set **INPUT** so the loudest parts peak around −6 dBFS on the LED meter.
2. Fix problems first on the **Parametric EQ**: a narrow cut on a resonance, a gentle air lift.
3. Shape the overall tone with the **Passive EQ**: broad shelves and wide bells.
4. Glue with the **Vari-Mu** (1–3 dB on loud parts), or the **Class-A** for cleaner, faster control.
5. Bring the level up with the **Maximizer**, ceiling at −1 dB, watching INTEGRATED on the loudness panel.
6. Compare with the plug-in bypassed at matched loudness, so louder doesn't fool your ears.

Useful moves

- **Mid/Side**: set the Class-A to M/S and compress only the Mid to steady vocals and bass without narrowing the stereo image.
- **Parallel compression**: on the Vari-Mu, set MIX to 30–50 % for density that keeps the transients.
- **Bass that pumps the mix**: switch on HP SC on the Vari-Mu, or tilt the Class-A's SC filter toward HP.
- **Tube warmth without compression**: TUBE ON with DRIVE at +3 to +6 dB; watch HARMONICS stay under about 1 %.
- **Streaming**: aim for −14 LUFS integrated and keep TRUE PEAK MAX below −1 dBTP.
- **Changing key**: switch KEY SHIFT while playback is stopped, and keep shifts within about 3 semitones.

On a single track

The track presets set an EQ and a compressor for one instrument. Insert the plug-in on that track, open the EQ **PRESETS** button, choose from **TRACK PRESETS**, and adjust the compressor's threshold until its meter shows the amount the notes suggest.

Troubleshooting and FAQ

Problem	What to do
The plug-in doesn't appear in my DAW	Rescan plug-ins in the DAW's settings. Check it was installed to the folder in *Installing*. On a Mac, Logic lists it only after its AU check passes.
macOS says Apple could not verify the installer	The build isn't signed and notarized. Right-click → **Open**, or **System Settings → Privacy & Security → Open Anyway**.
Pro Tools doesn't show it	Retail Pro Tools needs the PACE-signed AAX (see *Installing*). Unsigned builds load only in Pro Tools Developer.
The window is too big for my screen	Choose a smaller SIZE, press **SCROLL**, or use **MINI**. It never opens larger than the screen.
Nothing changes when I turn the Parametric EQ	Press the red **PUSH EQ**: the unit starts switched out. Check its channel switches are on **MAN**.
The Class-A does nothing	Switch on **ACTIVE**, then lower THRESHOLD until its meter moves.
The master sounds squashed	Look at the maximizer's GR bar: a constant 5–6 dB is too much. Lower GAIN or AMOUNT, or choose a quieter genre.
A knob jumped back to its default	Double-clicking a knob resets it. To zoom, double-click an empty spot instead.
The audio is delayed while KEY SHIFT is on	It adds 85 ms, which the DAW compensates. Switch it while stopped.

Problem	What to do
The Auto Master's plan seems wrong	Let it listen to the loudest part of the song. If your Parametric EQ or Class-A were set strangely, reset them; it plans around them.
Right channel won't move	**LINK** is on, so the right follows the left. Switch LINK off to set it separately.

Can I use it on single tracks? Yes. The track presets are made for that, and every unit works on any stereo source.

Will my old sessions still open? Yes. Sessions saved with earlier versions (including "Masterdesk Passive EQ") load with their settings.

Specifications and legal notes

Item	Value
Version	1.13.0
Formats	VST3 (macOS, Windows, Linux), AU (macOS), AAX for Pro Tools (macOS, Windows, stereo), standalone app
Channels	Stereo
Internal processing	4× oversampling below 88.2 kHz, 2× below 176.4 kHz, none above
Latency	133 samples at 48 kHz (fixed, includes the maximizer's 1.5 ms look-ahead); KEY SHIFT adds 85 ms while on
Loudness metering	EBU R128 / ITU-R BS.1770-4, true peak 4× oversampled
Spectrum	62 bands, 19 Hz–19 kHz, 0 to −62 dB
Automation	Every control is a host parameter that snaps to its detents

Notes

- The EQs and compressors are independent models styled on published behaviour of the Sontec MES-432C/9, Manley Massive Passive and Variable Mu, and elysia alpha compressor. They are not affiliated with or endorsed by those companies, and they are not component-level measurements of the hardware.
- Engineer presets use settings as given in lists supplied for the plug-in; they are not verified with or endorsed by the engineers named.
- Built with JUCE 8. The Pro Tools version uses Avid's AAX SDK, under Avid's licence or the GPL v3.
- © Basemental. All other trademarks belong to their owners.